

UBER Q&A

“SAFETY KEY FOR POPULARITY OF AUTONOMOUS CARS”

Sachin Kansal, Chief Product Officer, Uber, shares insights on the company’s autonomous vehicle strategy, AI-driven innovation, and the balance between human drivers and self-driving technology

BY CHETAN BHUTANI

18 | AS UBER ACCELERATES *into the future of mobility, Sachin Kansal, Chief Product Officer, in an interview with Business Today discusses partnerships, India’s potential in automated vehicles, and the road ahead for profitability and seamless global integration. Edited excerpts:*

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What was your team’s initial reaction when the first autonomous car rolled out?

I was here in January when we started testing, and collectively, the team was very excited. We have partnered with Waymo for a couple of years now, initially launching in Phoenix.

While there are fewer cars there, Austin has a larger fleet, and we plan

to expand that number to many hundreds between Austin and Atlanta.

The experience of using the Uber app to request an autonomous car, getting matched, and riding in it was phenomenal and highly motivating for the team.

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Many driver-partners are concerned about

a few dozen autonomous vehicles in Austin. We firmly believe in a hybrid network that includes both human drivers and couriers alongside autonomous vehicles. That’s why our platform is built as a hybrid system.

There are several factors to consider. First, automated vehicles (AVs) currently operate within specific geofenced areas

enough AVs to meet the high demand during peak traffic hours without having excess idle vehicles at other times.

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Many countries, including India, are making significant strides in AI-driven transportation, with growing demand for ADAS-equipped cars.

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potential job losses as autonomous vehicles become more prevalent. How is Uber addressing these concerns?

Currently, we have only

and are limited to a few cities. Many pickup and drop-off locations are still better served by human drivers and couriers.

More importantly, it’s impossible to have

Do you see a future for autonomous vehicles in India?

Two key things need to happen. First, the technology must be capable of operating